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Bonum est homini ut eum veritas vincat volentem, quia malum est homini ut eum veritas vincat invitum. Nam ipsa vincat necesse est, sive negantem sive confitentem.
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ENCYCLICAL LETTER OF OUR MOST HOLY LORD PIUS X.

BY DIVINE PROVIDENCE POPE.

ON THE TER-CENTENARY OF THE CANONIZATION OF ST. CHARLES BORROMEO.

To the Patriarchs, Primates, Archbishops, Bishops and other Ordinaries in Peace and Communion with the Apostolic See.

PIUS X. POPE.

Venerable Brothers, Health and the Apostolic Benediction.

WHAT the Divine word time and again records in the Sacred Scriptures—that the just man shall live in eternal memory of praise, and that he speaks even when dead (Ps. cxi., 7; Prov. x., 7; Hebr. xi., 4)—is specially verified by the voice and the continued work of the Church. For she, mother and nurse of sanctity that she is, ever rejuvenated and rendered fruitful by the breath of "the Holy Spirit who dwells within us" (Rom. viii., 11), as she alone generates, nourishes and brings up within her bosom the most noble family of the just, so, too, she is the most solicitous, by an instinct as it were of maternal love, in preserving their memory and in stimulating love for them. And from this remembrance she derives a comfort that is almost divine and that draws her eyes from the miseries of this mortal pilgrimage to see in the saints "her joy and her crown," to recognize in them the sublime image of her heavenly Spouse, and to inculcate upon her children with new evidence the old truth: "To them that love God all things work together unto good, to such as, according to His purpose, are called to be saints." (Rom. viii., 28.) And their glorious works are not only a comfort to the memory, but a light for imitation and a strong incentive to virtue through that unanimous echo of the saints which responds to the voice of Paul: "Be ye followers of me, as I also am of Christ." (I. Cor. iv., 16.)

For these reasons, Venerable Brothers, when we immediately on our elevation to the Supreme Pontificate made known our intention of working constantly that "all things might be restored in Christ," in our first encyclical letter (Litt. Encycl. "E supremi" die IV. m. October MCMIII.), we studied earnestly to make all turn their eyes with us to Jesus, "the Apostle and Pontiff of our confession, the Author and Finisher of our faith." (Hebr. iii., 1; xii., 2-3.) But since our weakness is such that we are apt to be confounded by the great-

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ness of such an Exemplar, we had, through the kindness of Divine Providence, another model to propose, one who while being as close to Christ as it is possible for human nature to reach, is better adapted to our weakness—namely, the ever Blessed Virgin, the august Mother of God. (Litt. Encycl. "Ad diem illum," die II. m. Februar, MCMIV.) Moreover, availing ourself of various occasions to revive the memory of the saints, we have held up for universal admiration those faithful servants and ministers in the house of God, and each in his proper degree those friends of His and members of His household, "who by faith conquered kingdoms, wrought justice, obtained promises" (Hebr. xi., 33), that we might be urged on by their example "that henceforth we be no more children, tossed to and fro, and carried about with every wind of doctrine by the wickedness of men, by cunning craftiness, by which they lie in wait to deceive; but doing the truth in charity, we may in all things grow up in Him who is the head, even Christ." (Eph. iv., 11 seq.)

This most lofty design of Divine Providence we showed forth as realized in the highest degree in three personages who flourished as great doctors and pastors at periods far apart, but each of them almost equally calamitous for the Church—Gregory the Great, John Chrysostom and Anselm of Aosta, whose solemn centenaries have fallen in these latter years. Thus more especially in the two encyclical letters given on March 12, 1904, and on April 21, 1909, we expounded those points of doctrine and precepts of Christian life, which seemed to us to be suitable for our own times and which are to be found in the example and teaching of these saints.

And since we are persuaded that the illustrious examples set by the soldiers of Christ are far better calculated to stir and draw souls than words or deep treatises (Encycl. "E supremi"), we now gladly avail ourself of another happy opportunity which is presented to us to commend the most useful lessons to be drawn from another holy pastor raised up by God in times nearer to our own and amid tempests almost identical with those through which we are passing, that Cardinal of Holy Roman Church and Archbishop of Milan, Charles Borromeo, by Paul V. of holy memory numbered among the saints. And not less better adapted to our purpose, for, to quote the words of our predecessor, "the Lord, who alone works great wonders, has done magnificent things with us in these latter times, and in His wonderful dispensation He has erected a great luminary above the apostolic rock, by choosing Charles from the bosom of the Most Holy Roman Church to be a faithful priest, a good servant, a model for the flock and model for pastors; who, lighting up the whole Church with the varied brilliancy of his holy works, shines out before priests and people as an Abel in innocence, an Enoch in purity,

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a Jacob in bearing labors, a Moses in meekness, an Elias in burning zeal; who shows forth in himself for our imitation the authority of a Jeremia, amid an abundance of luxuries, the humility of a Martin in its highest grade, the pastoral solicitude of a Gregory, the liberty of an Ambrose, the charity of a Paulinus; who, in fine, gives us to see with our eyes and to touch with our hands a man who, while the world smiles with all its blandishments upon him, lives crucified to the world, lives of the spirit, trampling earthly things underfoot, seeking continuously the things of heaven, and that not merely because by his office occupying the place of an angel, but because he strove on earth to think the thoughts and do the works of the life of the angels." (Ex Bulla "Unigenitus" Gal. Nov. anno MDCX.)

Thus our predecessor five lustres after the death of Charles. And now, three centuries after the glorification decreed to him, "with good reason are our lips full of joy and our tongue of exultation on the great day of our solemnity, whereon with the decreeing of the sacred honors to Charles, Cardinal Priest of the Holy Roman Church, over which by the disposition of the Lord we preside, a crown rich in all precious stones was given to his only Spouse." Thus we have in common with our predecessor the confidence that from the contemplation of the glory and still more from the teaching and example of the saints, the frowardness of the impious may be humiliated and confounded all those who "glory in the simulacrums of their errors." (Ex eadem Bulla "Unigenitus.") Thus the renewal of the glorification of Charles, model of the flock and of pastors in modern times, unwearied defender and advocate of the true Catholic reform against those innovators whose aim was not the restoration, but rather the deformation and destruction of faith and morals, will serve after three centuries as a source of special comfort and instruction for all Catholics and a noble incentive to them to coöperate strenuously in the work we have so much at heart of the restoration of all things in Christ.

It is certainly well known to you, Venerable Brothers, that the Church, although ever in tribulation, is never left by God wholly without consolation. "For Christ loved the Church and delivered Himself up for it, that He might sanctify it . . . and present it to Himself a glorious Church, not having spot or wrinkle, or any such thing, but that it should be holy and without blemish." (Eph. v., 25 sqq.) Nay, when the licentiousness of morals is most unbridled, the onslaught of persecution most fierce and most cunning the wiles of error that seem to threaten her with utter ruin and that tear from her bosom not a few of her children, to plunge them in the vortex of impiety and vice, it is then that the Church finds Divine protection

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more efficacious than ever. For, with or without the consent of the wicked, God makes error itself serve for the triumph of the truth, of which the Church is the defender and the guardian; makes corruption serve for the increase of sanctity, of which she is the nursing mother and mistress, and persecution serve for a more wonderful "freedom" from "our enemies." And thus it happens that when to profane eyes the Church seems to be buffeted and almost submerged by the rage of the storm, it is then she comes forth fairer, stronger, purer, refulgent with the splendor of the greatest virtues.

In this way the supreme goodness of God ever confirms with new proofs that the Church is a Divine work, because in the most painful trial, that of the errors and sins which insinuate themselves in its very members, He makes her triumph in the combat, because He shows in it the truth of the words of Christ: "The gates of hell shall not prevail against it" (Matth. xvi., 18), because He proves by the reality the truth of the promise, "Behold I am with you all days, even to the consummation of the world" (Matth. xxviii., 20), and finally because He gives testimony of that mysterious virtue by which another Paraclete, promised by Christ immediately on His return to heaven, continually pours out His gifts upon it and defends and controls it in all tribulation; a "Spirit who abides with it forever; the spirit of truth, whom the world cannot receive, because it seeth him not nor knoweth him . . . because he shall abide in you, and shall be in you." (Ioan. xiv., 16 sqq.; xvi., 7 sqq.) From this fount wells the life and force of the Church, and by this, too, as the ecumenical Vatican Council teaches, it is distinguished from all other societies by the manifest notes wherewith it is signalized and constituted "as a banner raised up among the nations." (Sessio III., Const. "Dei Filius," cau. 3.)

And truly, only a miracle of the Divine power could ensure that the Church, amid the flood of corruption and the lapses of its members, as the mystic body of Christ remains indefectible in the holiness of its doctrine, of its laws, of its end; from these same causes derives fruitful results; from the faith and justice of many of her children gathers most copious fruits of salvation. No less clear appears the seal of its divine life in that amid so vast and foul a mass of perverse opinions, amid such numbers of rebels, amid so multiform a variety of errors, it perseveres immutable and constant, "as the pillar and ground of truth," in the profession of one and the same doctrine, in the communion of the same sacraments, in its divine constitution, in its government, in its morals. And this is all the more wonderful inasmuch as the Church not only resists evil, but "conquers evil with good," and never ceases from blessing friends and enemies alike, while it works and yearns with all its soul to effect the Christian

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renovation of society as well as of the individuals that compose it. For this is its special mission in the world, and of this its very enemies experience the benefit.

This wonderful influx of Divine Providence in the work of restoration promoted by the Church shines forth with splendor in that century which, for the comfort of the good, saw the appearance of St. Charles Borromeo. In those days passions ran riot and the knowledge of the truth was almost completely perverted and obscured; there was a continual struggle with errors, and human society, going from bad to worse, seemed to be rushing towards the abyss. In the midst of these errors rose up proud and rebellious men, "enemies of the cross of Christ . . . men of earthly sentiments, whose god is their belly." (Philip. iii., 18, 19.) These, bent not on correcting morals, but on denying the dogmas, multiplied the disorders, loosening for themselves and for others the bridle of licentiousness and contemning the authoritative guidance of the Church to pander to the passions of the most corrupt princes and peoples, with a virtual tyranny overturned its doctrine, constitution, discipline.

Then, imitating these sinners to whom was addressed the menace, "Woe to you who call evil good and good evil" (Isai. v., 20), that tumult of rebellion and that perversion of faith and morals they called reformation and themselves reformers. But in truth they were corrupters, for, undermining with dissensions and wars the forces of Europe, they paved the way for the rebellions and the apostasy of modern times, in which were united and renewed in one onslaught those three kinds of conflict hitherto separated, from which the Church had always issued victorious—the bloody conflicts of the first ages, then the internal pest of heresies, and finally, under the name of evangelical liberty, a vicious corruption and a perversion of discipline unknown perhaps in mediæval times.

To this crowd of seducers God opposed real reformers and holy men to arrest the impetuous current and extinguish the conflagration and to repair the harm already done. Their assiduous and manifold work for the reformation of discipline was all the more comforting to the Church by reason of the grave tribulation that afflicted it, and afforded a proof of the words, "God is faithful, who . . . also with temptation will make issue." (I. Cor. x., 13.) It was in these circumstances that by a providential disposition the singular zeal and sanctity of Charles Borromeo came to bring fresh consolation to the Church.

For God so ordained that his ministry was to have a force and efficacy all its own not only in checking the audacity of the factious, but in teaching and kindling the children of the Church. He curbed

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the mad ardors of the former and refused their futile charges with the most powerful eloquence, by the example of his life and labors; he raised the hopes of the latter and revived their zeal. And it was truly wonderful how from his youth he united in himself all those qualities of the real reformer, which in others we see scattered and isolated—virtue, sense, doctrine, authority, power, alacrity—and how he combined them all to serve for the defense of Catholic truth against the onrush of heresies, as is the proper mission of the Church, reviving the faith that had grown dormant and almost extinct in many, strengthening it by provident laws and institutions, restoring the discipline that had been dethroned, and strenuously leading back the morals of the clergy and people to the tenor of Christian life. Thus, while he accomplishes all the offices of the reformer, he also duly discharges all the functions of the "good and faithful servant," and later those of the great priest who "pleased God in his days and was found just," and therefore worthy to be taken as an example by all classes of persons, clergy and laity, rich and poor; like those whose excellence is summarized in the encomium of Bishop and prelate, by which beyond the words of the Apostle Peter he made himself a "pattern of the flock from the heart." (I. Petr. v., 3.) No less admirable is the fact that Charles, before reaching the age of twenty-three, although raised to the highest honors and entrusted with important and most difficult affairs of the Church, made daily progress in the more perfect exercise of virtue, through that contemplation of Divine things which in sacred retirement had already renewed him, and he shone forth "a spectacle to the world, to the angels and to men."

Then, indeed, to use again the words of our predecessor, Paul V., the Lord began to show forth in Charles "His wonders"—wisdom, justice, burning zeal in promoting the glory of God and the Catholic name, and above all things solicitude for that work of restoration of the faith and of the universal Church which was treated in the august gathering of Trent. The Pontiff himself and all posterity assigned to him the merit of the celebration of this Council, inasmuch as he, before becoming the most faithful executor of it, was its most efficacious promoter. Indeed, were it not for his many vigils, trials and labors, that work would not have attained its ultimate completion.

And yet all these things were but a preparation and a novitiate, in which his heart was trained with piety, his mind with study, his body with labor, while he always kept himself, modest and humble youth that he was, as clay in the hands of God and God's Vicar on earth. A life of preparation such as this was just the kind to be despised by the innovators of the time, through that same foolishness

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which leads the modern innovators to despise it, in their failure to observe that the wonderful works of God are brought to maturity in the shade and silence of the soul dedicated to obedience and prayer, and that in this preparation lies the germ of future progress as the hope of the harvest lies in the sowing.

The sanctity and laboriousness of Charles, who was then preparing himself under such auspices, developed in due course to produce marvelous fruit, as we have hinted already, when he, like the good workman he was, leaving the splendor and majesty of Rome, retired to the field that he was to cultivate in Milan, and discharging all his offices there better and better every day, brought it to such splendor, from the state of rank growths and wildness to which the evil times had so deplorably reduced it, as to make the Church of Milan a most brilliant example of ecclesiastical discipline. (Ex Bulla "Unigenitus.")

All these striking results he attained by adopting in his work of reformation the rules laid shortly before by the Council of Trent.

For the Church, knowing how well "the imagination and thought of man's heart are prone to evil" (Gen. viii., 21), never ceases to combat vice and error that "the body of sin may be destroyed, to the end that we may serve sin no longer." (Rom. vi., 6.) And in this conflict, as she is a mistress to herself and guided "by the grace which is diffused in our hearts by the Holy Ghost," so she is governed in her thought and action by the Doctor of the Gentiles, who says: "Be ye renewed in the spirit of your mind. And be not conformed to this world, but be reformed in the newness of your mind, that you may prove what is the good and the acceptable and the perfect will of God." (Rom. xii., 2.) And the son of the Church and true reformer never persuades himself that he has attained the goal, but with the Apostle only protests that he is striving towards it: "Forgetting the things that are behind, and stretching myself to those that are before, I press towards the mark, to the prize of the supernal vocation of God in Christ Jesus." (Philip. iii., 13, 14.)

Thus it is that, united with Christ in the Church, "we in all things grow up in Him who is the head, even Christ, from whom the whole body maketh its own increase unto the edifying of itself in charity" (Ephes. iv., 15, 16), and Mother Church realizes more and more that mystery of the Divine will "in the dispensation of the fullness of times to reëstablish all things in Christ." (Ephes. i., 9, 10.)

No thought was given to all this by the reformers opposed by St. Charles, for they presumed to reform faith and discipline at their own caprice; nor is it better understood, Venerable Brothers, by the Moderns, against whom we have to combat to-day. These, too,

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subvert the doctrine, laws, institutions of the Church, forever talking about culture and civilization, not because they have this so much at heart, but because under such sounding words they are enabled the better to conceal the evil nature of their designs.

Their real aims, their plots, the line they are following are well known to all of you, and their designs have been denounced and condemned by us. What they propose is a universal apostasy from the faith and discipline of the Church, an apostasy still worse than the one which threatened the century of Charles, from the fact that it creeps insidious and hidden in the very veins of the Church and with extreme subtlety pushes erroneous principles to their extreme conclusions.

But both have the same origin in "the enemy who," ever alert for the perdition of men, "has oversowed cockle among the wheat" (Matth. xiii., 25); of both revolts the ways are hidden and darksome, with the same development and the same fatal issue. For as in the past the first apostasy, turning to the side on which fortune seemed to favor it, stirred up the powerful against the people or the people against the powerful only to lead both classes to destruction, so this modern apostasy stimulates mutual hatred between the poor and the rich until people growing discontented with their lot lead lives more and more miserable and pay the penalty imposed on all who, absorbed in earthly and fleeting things, seek not "the kingdom of God and His justice." Nay, the present conflict has become all the more grave from the fact that while the turbulent innovators of other times as a rule retained some fragments of the treasure of revealed doctrrine, the Moderns would seem to have no peace until they have utterly destroyed it. Now, once the foundations of religion are thus overturned, the bonds of civil society are also necessarily broken. Truly a spectacle full of sadness for the present and of menace for the future; not because there is any ground for fears as to the safety of the Church, for here the Divine promises do not permit of doubt, but for the dangers that threaten the family and the nations, especially for those who foment with most activity or who tolerate with most indifference this pestiferous wind of impiety.

Amid so impious and so stupid a war, carried on sometimes and propagated with the aid of those who should be the first to support us and help our cause; amid this manifold transformation of error and these varied blandishments of vice, by both of which many even of our own allow themselves to be led astray, seduced as they are by the appearances of novelty and of doctrine, or by the illusion that the Church may well come to a friendly agreement with the maxims of the age, you are well aware, Venerable Brothers, that we must all oppose a vigorous resistance and repel the assault of the enemy with

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those very weapons which Charles Borromeo used in his own time.

And first of all, since they are attacking the very rock of faith, either by open denial, or by hypocritical assault, or by misrepresenting revealed doctrine, we shall do well to remember what St. Charles often inculcated, viz., that "The first and chief care of pastors must be concerned with all that regards the full and inviolate maintenance of the Catholic faith, the faith which the Holy Church professes and teaches, and without which it is impossible to please God." (Conc. Prov. i., sub initium.) And again: "In this matter no diligence can be too great to meet what are certainly the requirements of the case." (Conc. Prov. v., Pars. i.) Hence it is necessary to oppose sound doctrine to "the leaven of heretical depravity," which if not repressed corrupts the whole mass; that is, we must oppose the perverse opinions which are making their way under lying semblances and which taken together are professed by "modernism," remembering with St. Charles "how supreme must be the zeal and how diligent above all else must be the care of the Bishop to combat the crime of heresy." (Conc. Prov. v., Pars. i.)

In truth, it is not necessary to record the other words of the saint in quoting the sanctions, laws, penalties laid down by the Roman Pontiffs against prelates who are negligent or remiss in purging their dioceses of the evil of heresy. But it will be quite opportune to mediate closely on the conclusions he draws from these: "Hence the Bishop must above all things persevere in this eternal solicitude and continuous vigilance not only to prevent the most pestilent disease of heresy from penetrating among the flock committed to him, but even to remove the faintest suspicion of it from them. And should it happen to penetrate, which may the Lord Christ in His pitiful mercy forbid, he must strive at once by all means in his power to have it driven out immediately, and he must have those who are infected or under suspicion of being infected with the pestilence treated according to the pontifical canons and sanctions." (Conc. Prov. v., Pars. i.)

But neither liberation nor preservation from the pest of error is possible except through proper instruction of the clergy, for "faith cometh by hearing and hearing by the word of Christ." (Rom. x., 17.) This necessity of inculcating the truth upon all is more than ever urgent in our days, when through all the veins of the State, and from sources whence it might have been least expected, we see the poison penetrates to such a degree that all come within the scope of the reasons alleged by St. Charles in these words: "If those who live close to the heretics be not firm and well-grounded in the foundations of the faith, there is only too much reason to fear that they will easily allow themselves to be drawn by them into some snare

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of impiety or false doctrine." (Conc. Prov. v., Pars. i.) For nowadays owing to the facility of travel the means of communication have been increased for error as well as for all other things, and by reason of the unbridled liberty of the passions we live in the midst of a perverted society, in which "there is no truth . . . and the knowledge of God does not exist" (Os. iv., 1); "in a land that is desolate . . . because no one thinketh in the heart." (Ierem. xii., 11.) Hence we, to use the words of St. Charles, "have hitherto employed much diligence to ensure that the faithful of Christ all and several be well instructed in the rudiments of the Christian faith" (Conc. Prov. v., Pars. i.), and have written a special encyclical letter on the subject as being one of the most vital importance. (Encycl. "Acerbo nimis," die XXV. m. Aprilis MDCCCCV.) But although we do not wish to repeat what Charles Borromeo in his burning zeal lamented, that "we have hitherto obtained all too little success in a matter of such moment," yet, like him, "swayed by the vastness of the undertaking and of the danger," we would still further kindle the zeal of all, to the end that, taking Charles as their model, they may contribute, each in his grade and according to his strength, in this work of Christian restoration. Let fathers and employers remember with what fervor the holy Bishop constantly inculcated upon them not only to afford the opportunity, but to impose the obligation of learning Christian doctrine upon their children, servants and employes. Let clerics remember that they must help the parish priests in this teaching, and let the parish priests have schools for the purpose multiplied according to the number and the necessities of their people, and see to it that they be commendable in the probity of the teachers, who should be assisted by men and women of tried morality, after the method prescribed by the holy Archbishop of Milan. (Conc. Prov. v., Pars. i.)

The necessity of this Christian instruction is obviously increased both by the trend of modern times and customs, and especially by the existence of those public schools, destitute of all religion, in which everything most holy is ridiculed and condemned, and in which the lips of the teachers and the ears of the scholars are equally open to blasphemy. We speak of those schools which with supreme injustice are called "lay" or "neutral," but which in reality are the prey of the domineering tyranny of a darksome sect. This new trick of hypocritical liberty you have already denounced aloud and fearlessly, Venerable Brothers, especially in those countries where the rights of religion and of the family have been most shamelessly trampled upon, and in which the very voice of nature, proclaiming that the faith and innocence of youth must be respected, has been stifled. To remedy, as far as was possible for us, so great an evil inflicted by

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those same persons who while they claim obedience to themselves deny it to the Supreme Master of all things, we have recommended that schools of Christian doctrine be established in the various cities. And while this work, thanks to your efforts, has already made good progress, still it is earnestly to be desired that it be propagated even more widely, and that these schools be established numerously everywhere, and be provided with teachers of sound doctrine and good life.

These same qualities are with much greater reason to be looked for in the sacred orator whose office is closely connected with that of the necessary instruction in the first elements of religious teaching. Hence the diligence and the counsels of Charles in the provincial and diocesan synods were directed with a most special care to the formation of preachers who might be employed with holy zeal and good fruit in "the ministry of the word." And this, too, and perhaps even more urgently, seems to be required in the times in which we live, when the faith is weakening in so many hearts, and when there is no lack of those who in a spirit of vainglory follow the fashions, "adulterating the word of God" and depriving souls of the food of life.

With the utmost vigilance, therefore, Venerable Brothers, we must see to it that our flock be not fed on wind by vain and frivolous men, but be nourished with life-giving food by "ministers of the word," of whom it may be said: "Of Christ we are ambassadors, God as it were exhorting by us: Be reconciled to God (II. Cor. v., 20), not walking in craftiness, nor adulterating the word of God, but by manifestation of the truth commending ourselves to every man's conscience in the sight of God (II. Cor. iv., 2); workmen that need not to be ashamed, rightly handling the word of truth." (II. Tim. ii., 15.) Not less useful for us will be those most holy and most fruitful rules which the Bishop of Milan was accustomed to lay down for the faithful and which are summarized in the words of St. Paul: "When you had received from us the word of the hearing of God you received it not as the word of men, but (as it is indeed) the word of God, who worketh in you who have believed." (I. Thess. ii., 13.)

Thus "the word of God, living and effectual and more piercing than any two-edged sword" (Hebr. iv., 12), will work not only for the conservation and defense of the faith, but as an efficacious impulse to good works, for "faith without works is dead (Iacob. ii., 26), for not the hearers of the law are just before God, but the doers of the law shall be justified." (Rom. ii., 13.)

Here, too, we see again how immense is the difference between real and false reform. For those who advocate the false, imitating

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the inconstancy of the foolish, are wont to rush to extremes, either by exalting faith in such a way as to exclude good works, or ascribing to nature alone all the excellence of virtue without the aid of faith and divine grace. Whereas the acts proceeding from merely natural uprightness are but the simulacra of virtue, neither lasting in themselves nor sufficient for salvation. The work of such reformers, therefore, is not adapted to restore discipline, but is fatal to faith and morals.

On the other hand, those who, like St. Charles, sincerely and straightforwardly seek true and salutary reform, avoid extremes and never outstep those limits beyond which true reform cannot subsist. United as they are in the closest links with the Church and its Head, Christ, they not only derive thence strength for their interior life, but learn rules for their public action to enable them to devote themselves with sure purpose to the work of healing human society. Now, of this divine mission, transmitted perpetually to those who have to be the legates of Christ, it is the function "to teach all nations," and not only the things that are to be believed, but the things that are to be done, that is, as Christ Himself said: "Observe all things whatsoever I have commanded you." (Matth. xxviii., 18-20.) "For He is the way, the truth and the life" (Ioan. xiv., 6), and He came that men "may have life and have it more abundantly." (Ioan. x., 10.) But since to fulfill all those duties with the sole guidance of nature is something far beyond what the forces of man can by themselves attain, the Church possesses, together with her magisterium, the power of governing human society and that of sanctifying it, while she communicates the opportune and necessary means of salvation through those who, in their several grades and offices, are her ministers and coöperators.

Understanding this well, the true reformers do not kill the blossom in order to save the root, that is, they do not separate faith from holiness of life, but foster both of them and warm them with the breath of charity, which is "the bond of perfection." (Coloss. iii., 14.) Thus, obeying the Apostle, do they "keep the deposit" (I. Tim. vi., 20), not to obstruct its manifestation or dim its light for the nations, but rather to send farther and wider the most saving waters of truth and life which well from that spring. And in this they combine theory with practice, availing themselves of the former to prevent all the "wiles of error," and of the latter to apply the precepts to the morals and action of life. Therefore, too, they provide all the means opportune or necessary for the attainment of the end, both as regards the extirpation and "for the perfection of the saints, for the work of the ministry, the building up of the body of Christ." (Eph. iv., 12.) This was the scope of the statutes, the canons, the

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laws of the Fathers and Councils, and all those means of instruction, government, sanctification and beneficence of all kinds, and, in fine, all the discipline and activity of the Church. On such masters as these of faith and morals the true son of the Church fixes his eyes and his heart when he aims at the reformation of himself and others. And on such masters, too, Borromeo relies in his reformation of ecclesiastical discipline. He often refers to them, as when he writes: "We, following the ancient custom of the Holy Fathers and the sacred Councils, and especially of the Ecumenical Synod of Trent, have laid down many dispositions concerning these same points in our preceding provincial Councils." (Conc. Prov. v., Pars. i.) So, too, in making provision for the suppression of public scandals, he declares that he is guided "both by the law and by the sacred sanctions of the sacred canons, and, above all, of the Council of Trent." (Conc. Prov. v., Pars. i.)

And not content with this, in order the better to ensure that he may never depart from this rule, he is wont to conclude the statutes of his provincial Synods thus: "The things all and single which have been decreed and done by us in this provincial Synod, we submit always, to be amended and corrected, to the authority and judgment of the Roman Church, of all churches the Mother and Mistress." (Conc. Prov. vi., sub finem.) And this purpose of his he showed forth ever more fervently as he advanced with giant strides in the perfection of the active life, not only while the Chair of Peter was occupied by the Pontiff who was his uncle, but also under the successors of the latter, Pius V. and Gregory XIII. The election of these he powerfully aided, and he supported them strenuously in their great undertakings, corresponding perfectly with what they expected from him.

But above all did he second them in putting into execution the practical means to attain the end in view, viz., the real reform of sacred discipline. Here again he showed himself as far as possible removed from the false reformers who mask their obstinate disobedience under an appearance of zeal. Beginning "the judgment of the house of God" (I. Peter iv., 17), he applied himself first of all to reform the discipline of the clergy by constant laws, and to this end erected seminaries for the students for the priesthood, founded a congregation of priests known as Oblates, united religious families ancient and modern, assembled Councils, and by provisions of all kinds assured and developed the work that had been undertaken. Then, without delay, he set his hand with equal vigor to reform the morals of the people, regarding as said to himself what was said to the Prophet: "Lo, I have set the . . . to root up, and to pull down, and to waste, and to destroy, and to build, and to plan." (Ier.

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i., 10.) Thus the good shepherd that he was, visiting personally the churches of the province, not without fatigue, like the Divine Master "he went about doing good and healing" the wounds of the flock; he put forth every effort to suppress and eradicate the abuses he met on all sides, due either to ignorance or the neglect of the laws; to the perversion of ideas and the corruption of morals that abounded he raised up barriers in the form of the schools and colleges he opened for the children and for youth, the Marian societies which he developed after having seen them in their early flowering here in Rome, the hospices he threw open for the orphans, the refuges he established for girls in danger, for widows, for mendicants, for men and women rendered destitute by sickness or old age, by his protection of the poor against the tyranny of masters, against usurers, against the enslaving of children, and by great numbers of other institutions. But all this he effected shunning entirely the methods of those who would renew human society after their own fashion by overturning everything, by agitation, by vain noise, forgetting the Divine words: "The Lord is not found in commotion." (III. Reg. xix., 11.)

Just here is another point in which the real reformers differ from the false, as you, Venerable Brothers, have often experienced. The false reformers "seek their own interests, not those of Jesus Christ" (Philip. ii., 21), and giving ear to the insidious invitation once made to the Divine Master, "Manifest thyself to the world" (Ioan. vii., 4), they also repeat the ambitious words, "Let us also get us a name," and by this temerity, which we have, alas! to deplore in our own time, "some priests fell in battle, wishing to do great things they went out without prudence." (I. Machab. v., 57, 67.)

The true reformer, on the contrary, "seeks not his own glory, but the glory of Him who hath sent him" (Ioan. vii., 18), and like Christ, his exemplar, "he shall not contend nor cry, and his voice shall not be heard abroad, he shall not be turbulent or unquiet" (Isai. xlii., 2 sq.; Matth. xii., 19), but he shall be "meek and humble of heart." (Matth. xi., 29.) Hence he will please the Lord and bear most copious fruits of salvation.

In still another way are they distinguished from one another, for the false "trusteth in man and maketh flesh his arm" (Ier. xvii., 5), while the true reformer puts all his trust in God and looks to Him and to supernatural assistance for all his strength and virtue, exclaiming with the Apostle: "All things I can do in Him who strengtheneth me." (Philip iv., 13.)

These aids, which Christ communicated in rich abundance, the faithful reformer looks for in the Church itself, to which they have been given for the salvation of all, and among them especially

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prayer, sacrifice, the sacraments, which become "a fountain of water springing up to life everlasting." (Ioan. iv., 14.) But all such means are repugnant to those who by crooked ways and in forgetfulness of God busy themselves with reformation and who never cease trying to render turbid or dry up altogether those crystal springs, so that the flock of Christ may be deprived of them. And here they are even surpassed by their modern followers, who under a mask of the deepest religiousness hold in no account these means of salvation, and throw discredit on them, especially the two sacraments by which sin is pardoned for penitent souls and souls are strengthened with celestial food. Let all faithful pastors, therefore, endeavor with all zeal to ensure that benefits of such great price be held in the highest honor, nor suffer these two works of Divine charity to languish in the affections of men.

Such was the conduct of Borromeo, among whose writings we read: "Since the fruit of the sacraments is so great and so abundant that its value cannot easily be explained, they should be treated and received with the utmost diligence, with the deepest piety of the soul and with external cult and veneration." (Conc. Prov. i., Pars. ii.) Most worthy of note also are the recommendations with which he exhorts parish priests and preachers to revive the ancient practice of frequent communion, as we have also done by our decree, "Tridentina Synodus." "Parish priests and preachers," says the holy Bishop, "should exhort the people as often as possible to the most salutary practice of receiving the Holy Eucharist frequently, relying on the institutions and examples of the early Church, on the recommendations of the most authoritative Fathers, on the doctrine of the Roman Catechism, which treats of this matter at length, and finally on the teaching of the Council of Trent, which would have the faithful communicate in every Mass, not only by receiving the Eucharist spiritually, but also sacramentally." (Conc. Prov. iii., Pars. i.) He describes, too, the intention and affection with which this sacred banquet should be approached, in these words: "The people should not only be incited to receive the Most Holy Sacrament frequently, but should also be warned how dangerous and fatal it is to approach unworthily this sacred table of Divine food." (Conc. Prov. iv., Pars. ii.) The same diligence would seem to be especially necessary in our times of vacillating faith and charity grown cold in order that the increase in frequency may not be accompanied by a diminution in the reverence due to so great a mystery, but that rather it may bring with it a motive to make "man prove himself and so eat of that bread and drink of that chalice." (I. Cor. xi., 28.)

From these founts will spring a rich stream of grace, which will give vigor and nourishment also to natural and human means. The

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action of the Christian will by no means neglect the things that are of use and solace to life, for they, too, come from the same God, the Author of grace and of nature; but it will be careful when seeking and enjoying external things and the goods of the body not to make of them the end and happiness of life. He who uses these human things rightly and temperately, therefore, will employ them for the salvation of souls, in obedience to the words of Christ: "Seek first the kingdom of God and His justice and all these things will be added unto you." (Luc. xii., 31; Matth. vi., 33.)

This properly ordered and wise use of the means is so far from being in opposition with happiness of a lower kind, viz., that proper to human society, that, on the contrary, it serves greatly to promote its interests; not by vain boasting, as is the fashion with factious reformers, but by deeds and by heroic striving, even to the sacrifice of property, strength and life itself. Many an example of this fortitude is given us by Bishops who, in evil days for the Church, vieing with the zeal of Charles, realize the words of the Divine Master: "The good shepherd gives his life for his sheep." (Ioan. x., 11.) They are led to sacrifice themselves for the good, influenced not by ambition for glory, or by party spirit, or by the stimulus of any private interest, but by that "charity which never faileth." Kindled by this flame, which escapes profane eyes, Borromeo, after having exposed his life in attending the victims of the plague, did not confine himself to affording aid against present evils, but turned his solicitude to those which the future might have in store: "It is altogether reasonable that just as an excellent father who loves his children with a single-hearted affection provides for their future as well as their present, by preparing for them what is necessary for their lives, so we, moved by the duty of paternal love, are making provision with all foresight for the faithful of our province and are preparing for the future those aids which we have known by experience during the time of the plague to be salutary." (Conc. Prov. v., Pars. ii.)

The same designs and plans of affectionate forethought, Venerable Brothers, find a practical application in that Catholic action which we have frequently recommended. To take part in this most noble apostolate, which embraces all the works of mercy that are to be rewarded with the eternal kingdom (Matth. xxv., 34 sq.), the elite are called. But when they assume this burden they must be ready and fit to make a complete sacrifice of themselves and all things belonging to them for the good cause, to bear envy, contradiction and even the hatred of many who will repay their benefits with ingratitude, to labor like "good soldiers of Christ (II. Tim. ii., 3), to run by patience to the fight proposed to us, looking on Jesus, the author

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and finisher of faith." (Hebr. xii., 1-2.) A conflict, assuredly, of great difficulty, but one that is most efficacious for the well-being of civil society, even though complete victory be slow in coming.

In this respect, too, it is given to us to admire the splendid example set by St. Charles and to derive from it, each according to his own condition, matter for imitation and comfort. For although his singular virtue, his marvelous activity and his abundant charity made him worthy of so much respect, yet even he was not exempt from the law: "All that will live godly in Christ Jesus shall suffer persecution." (II. Tim. iii., 12.) Thus the very fact that he led a very austere life; that he always stood up for righteousness and honesty; that he was an incorruptible defender of law and justice, brought upon him the hostility of powerful men and the trickeries of diplomats, caused him later to be distrusted by the nobility, the clergy and the people, and eventually drew upon him the deadly hatred of the wicked, so that his very life was sought. Yet, though of a mild and gentle disposition, he held out against all this with invincible courage.

Never did he yield in anything that would be hurtful to faith and morals or in the face of claims contrary to discipline or burdensome on the faithful, even when these were made by a most powerful monarch, who was also a Catholic. Mindful of the words of Christ, "Give unto Cæesar the things that are Cæesar's and to God the things that are God's" (Matt. xxii., 21), and of the declaration of the Apostles, "It is better to obey God rather than men" (Acts v., 29), he became a supreme benefactor not only of the cause of religion, but of civil society itself, which, paying the penalty of its foolish prudence and almost overwhelmed by the storms of sedition which itself had raised, was rushing upon certain destruction.

The same praise and gratitude will be due to the Catholics of our time and to their courageous leaders, the Bishops, when they never fail in any of the duties of good citizens, either when it is a question of showing loyalty and respect to "wicked rulers" when these command what is just, or resisting their commands when they are iniquitous, holding themselves equally aloof from the frowned rebellion of those who have recourse to sedition and tumult and from the servile abjection of those who receive as sacred laws the manifestly impious statutes of perverse men, who under the lying name of liberty subvert all things and impose on those subject to them the hardest kind of tyranny.

This is happening in the sight of the whole world and in the full light of modern civilization, in some nations especially, where "the powers of darkness" seem to have taken up their headquarters. Under this domineering tyranny all the rights of the children of the

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Church are being trampled upon and the hearts of those in power have become closed to all those sentiments of generosity, courtesy and faith which for so long shone forth in their forefathers, who gloried in the name of Christians. But it is evident that where hatred of God and of the Church exists everything goes backward precipitously towards the barbarism of ancient liberty, or rather towards that most cruel yoke from which only the family of Christ and the education introduced by it has freed us. Borromeo expressed the same thought when he said: "It is a certain and well recognized fact that by no other crime is God more gravely offended, by none provoked to greater wrath, than by the vice of heresy, and that nothing contributes more to the ruin of provinces and kingdoms than this frightful pest." (Conc. Prov. v., Pars. i.) Yet as far more deadly must be regarded the modern conspiracy to tear Christian nations from the bosom of the Church, as we have already said.

For the enemies of the Church, although in utter discord of thought and will among themselves, which is the sure mark of error, are at one only in their obstinate assaults upon truth and justice; and as the Church is the guardian and defender of both of those, against the Church alone they close up their ranks for an united attack. And although they are wont to proclaim their impartiality and to assert that they are promoting the cause of peace, in reality, by their mild words and their avowed intentions, they are only laying snares to add insult to injury, treason to violence. A new species of war is, therefore, now being waged against Christianity, and one far more dangerous than those conflicts of other times, in which Borromeo won so much glory.

By taking example and instruction from him we shall be animated to battle vigorously for those lofty interests upon which depends the salvation of the individual and of society, for faith and religion and the inviolability of public right; we shall fight, it is true, under the spur of a bitter necessity, but at the same time cheered by the fair hope that the omnipotence of God will speed the victory for those who fight so glorious a battle—a hope which gathers greater strength from the powerful efficacy, persisting down to our own days, of the work done by St. Charles both in humbling pride and in strengthening the resolution to restore all things in Christ.

And now, Venerable Brothers, we may conclude in the words with which our predecessor, Paul V., already several times mentioned, concluded the letter decreeing the supreme honors to Charles: "It is right, meanwhile, that we render glory and honor and blessing to Him who lives through all ages, who blessed our fellow-servant with all spiritual benediction to make him holy and spotless in His sight. And the Lord having given him to us a star shining this

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night of sin and of our tribulation, let us have recourse to the Divine clemency, supplicating by mouth and deed that Charles, who loved the Church so ardently and helped her so greatly by his merits and example, may now assist her by his patronage, and in the day of wrath make peace for us through Christ our Lord." (Bulla "Unigenitus.")

To this prayer be added for the fulfillment of all hopes the token of the Apostolic Benediction, which with warm affection we impart to you, Venerable Brothers, and to the clergy and people of each one of you.

Given at Rome at St. Peter's, May 26, 1910, in the seventh year of our Pontificate.

PIUS X., POPE.

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